Algebraic World Model: From Exploration to Proofs

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Abstract

AI has made remarkable progress in mathematics, solving challenging problems with machine-checkable proofs in Lean, yet typically relying on predefined mathematical definitions and formal specifications. This raises a natural question: can it reason rigorously about an unknown world? We introduce the Algebraic World Model (AWM), a framework that turns interaction with unfamiliar environments into explicit mathematical models supporting formal reasoning. AWM explores the environment and develops executable Python hypotheses, continually testing and revising them against observations. It then structures these hypotheses into typed objects and shared rules, simplifies their structure through category-theory-inspired transformations, and formalizes the resulting model in Lean 4 to prove reachability and impossibility. AWM can formally prove that a goal is unreachable, even beyond explored trajectories. On two impossible game levels, it constructs closed, kernel-checked Lean proofs excluding every legal winning sequence in all six runs, while Claude Opus 5.5 and GPT-6 Astra, equipped with coding tools, produce none in twelve baseline runs. Four of AWM's six initial bounds are correct, compared with one for Opus 5.5 and none for GPT-6 Astra; given only feedback that a cheaper win exists, AWM revises its rules and constructs new proofs, reaching six of six correct bounds. Moreover, AWM produces interpretable mathematical models whose rules can be inspected and tested step by step. Across all 25 public ARC-AGI-3 games, these models enable Lean to replay the winning trajectories of all 183 levels and generalize beyond observed play, predicting unseen transitions and detecting changes in game mechanics. With Claude Opus 5, AWM clears all levels with a score of 99.9, while its certified winning trajectories use only 43% of the human baseline's actions.

1 Introduction

Artificial intelligence systems now produce Lean proofs of mathematical olympiad problems and some open Erdős problems (Achim et al., 2025; Hubert et al., 2026; Sothanaphan, 2026; Tsoukalas et al., 2026). These advances typically rely on predefined mathematical definitions and formal specifications. In an unfamiliar environment, however, an agent must first identify the relevant objects, infer how actions change them, and determine what constitutes success. The rules on which its reasoning depends are themselves hypotheses to be learned and revised through interaction. This raises a broader question:

Can an agent reason rigorously about an unknown world?

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Euler's treatment of the Königsberg bridges illustrates the role of mathematical structure (Euler, 1741). Land masses become vertices and bridges become edges. A walk crossing every bridge exactly once pairs arrivals and departures at every vertex other than its endpoints, so at most two vertices can have odd degree. The Königsberg graph has four, ruling out every such walk without enumerating routes. A winning trajectory likewise establishes reachability, but proving that none exists requires reasoning about all legal sequences. When the environment is unfamiliar, the objects and rules needed for that reasoning must themselves be learned.

We introduce the Algebraic World Model (AWM), a framework that learns explicit mathematical models of unfamiliar environments through interaction and uses them for formal reasoning. AWM proceeds through three stages (Figure 1). In **Explore & Prototype**, the agent actively probes the environment and maintains executable hypotheses, testing and revising them against observed transitions. **Structure & Simplify** organizes these hypotheses into typed objects and rules, then uses category-theory-inspired transformations to identify shared structure and simplify its representation while preserving tested distinctions. In **Formalize & Prove**, AWM completes the model in Lean 4 (de Moura & Ullrich, 2021) and constructs kernel-checked proofs of reachability, impossibility, and other properties. A winning witness establishes reachability; an invariant or a suitable cost lower bound can exclude every legal winning sequence under the model.

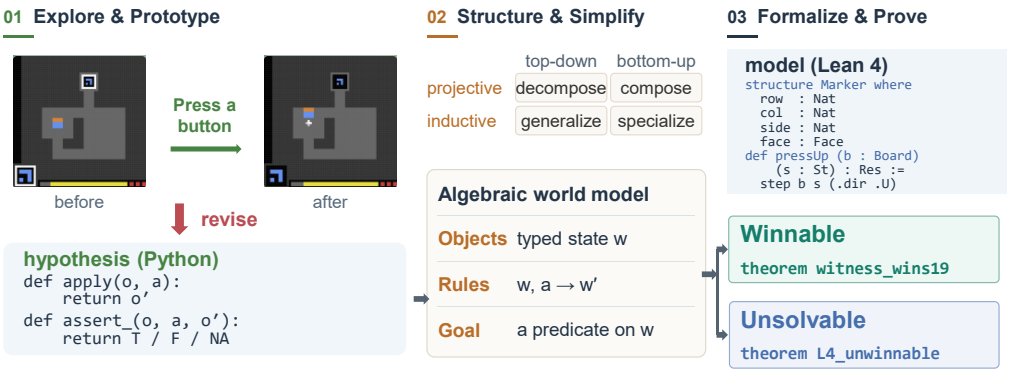


Figure 1: AWM's three-stage pipeline: interactive exploration builds a provisional executable model, algebraic transformations reveal and simplify its structure, and Lean 4 formalization enables certified proofs of reachability or impossibility.

We test AWM's ability to prove impossibility on ARC-AGI-3 (ARC Prize Foundation, 2026b), whose games reveal neither their rules nor their goals. We construct two impossible variants of `sc25` levels, preserving their mechanics while setting action budgets just below the minimum winning costs (§4). Across three runs per level, AWM produces closed, kernel-checked Lean proofs excluding all legal winning sequences under its learned models in all six runs. Claude Opus 5.5 and GPT-6 Astra produce no such proofs across twelve baseline runs.

The difference extends beyond proof construction. AWM's initial bounds match the minimum winning costs in four of six runs, compared with one for Opus 5.5 (without a proof) and none for Astra; other baseline runs report incorrect bounds or remain inconclusive. For example, on level 4 Astra claims impossibility with an unproved minimum winning cost of 22, whereas an AWM model proves a tight bound of 19, matching the game's actual minimum winning cost. Given only feedback that a cheaper win exists, AWM revises the rules underlying its remaining two bounds and constructs new closed proofs, bringing its bound accuracy to six of six.

AWM's learned mechanisms are also explicit and inspectable: typed objects and named rules make their predictions available for step-by-step checking. Across all 25 public ARC-AGI-3 games, AWM builds compact models with a median of six object types and ten rules. These models enable Lean to replay the winning trajectories of all 183 levels, checking represented state transitions and final goal conditions (§3). With Opus 5, AWM clears all 25 games with a score of 99.9, competitive with leading code-executing systems; its certified winning trajectories use 43% of the human baseline's actions.

We make three contributions.

- **A framework from exploration to algebraic structure.** AWM turns interaction with an unknown environment into executable hypotheses and organizes them into compact models through category-theory-inspired transformations. Shared, parameterized rules express related mechanisms in a common form, allowing their properties to be stated and proved uniformly (§2).
- **Formal impossibility reasoning in unknown worlds.** AWM constructs closed, kernel-checked Lean proofs that rule out all legal winning sequences under its learned rules and specified constraints, including sequences never explored. This establishes model-relative impossibility rather than inferring it from unsuccessful play (§4).
- **Inspectable models and traceable proofs.** Typed objects and named rules make learned dynamics understandable and their predictions checkable against observations. Lean replay connects the formal representation to recorded behavior, while explicit proof dependencies identify the rules on which a conclusion rests, supporting targeted empirical examination and revision (§3; §4.3).

2 Method

AWM aims to turn interaction with an unknown environment into a mathematical model that supports rigorous reasoning about both reachability and impossibility. This requires more than collecting rules that explain observed transitions: the rules must form a coherent representation of the environment, and that representation must support reasoning about action sequences the agent has never explored.

We first describe the target model (§2.1), then present the three stages that construct and use it (Figure 1): Explore & Prototype develops executable hypotheses through interaction; Structure & Simplify organizes them into a compact algebraic model; and Formalize & Prove completes the model in Lean 4 and establishes machine-checked results.

2.1 The Algebraic World Model

An algebraic world model describes an environment through typed objects, rules, and a goal predicate, represented in executable Python and formal Lean 4 to support both empirical testing and mathematical reasoning.

Objects. Object types define the structure and validity of states, providing a common vocabulary for describing the environment. A parser maps observations, together with any required history or auxiliary information, to typed states w.

Rules. Rules describe how actions transform these states. Each Python rule specifies an applicability scope and a checker that reports agreement, contradiction, or non-applicability on observed transitions; effect rules also predict successor states or their components. Together, the rules define legal actions, their effects and costs $\mathrm{cost}(w, a)$, while the goal predicate identifies successful states.

Related mechanisms can share a parameterized operation $r(\theta)$, with θ determined by the state. This allows common properties to be expressed and proved uniformly across different mechanisms.

Formal representation. The same model is formalized in Lean 4, with objects and rules encoded as definitions and properties of their dynamics expressed as theorems. Its executable representation supports testing against observations, while its formal representation supports kernel-checked proofs over legal action sequences (§2.4).

2.2 Explore & Prototype

Setting. We consider deterministic, goal-directed environments with partial observations, modeled in the POMDP setting (Kaelbling et al., 1998). At step t, the agent observes o_t, takes an action a_t, and receives o_{t+1} without access to the underlying state or transition function. Its experience forms a corpus $\mathcal{D}_t$ of distinct transitions $x = (o, a, o')$.

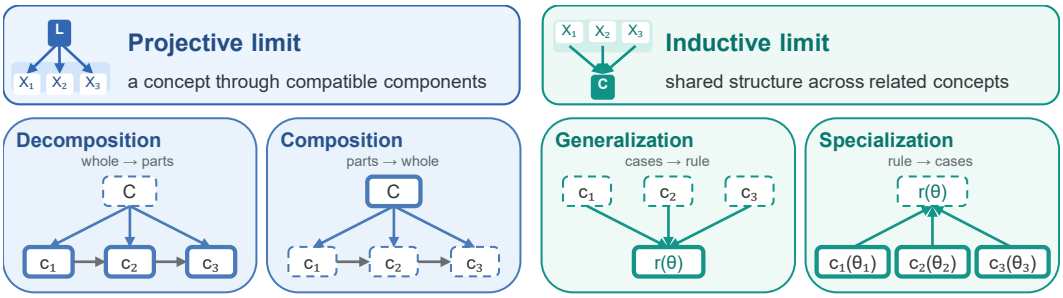


Figure 2: Four transformations inspired by projective and inductive limits, applied to object types and rules. Dashed boxes mark removed components and bold boxes mark introduced components; arrows indicate relationships between components. Generalization uses $r(\theta)$, and an instance is written $r(\theta_i)$; specialization makes distinctions explicit through case-specific types or parameters.

Building and testing hypotheses. AWM actively explores the environment and maintains a provisional executable model as a *concept book*. Each concept is a Python hypothesis about an environmental mechanism, containing a natural-language claim, an applicability scope, supporting transitions, a checker, and an optional predictor.

For a concept c, its checker returns $v_c(x)$: `TRUE` if the transition agrees with the hypothesis, `FALSE` if it contradicts it, and `NA` if it falls outside its scope. The optional predictor specifies expected action effects for comparison with subsequent observations.

After each action batch, AWM rechecks the concept book $\mathcal{C}_t$ against the expanded corpus $\mathcal{D}_t$. Further interaction is allowed only when

$$\forall c \in \mathcal{C}_t,\ \forall x \in \mathcal{D}_t : \quad v_c(x) \notin \{\mathsf{FALSE}, \mathsf{ERR}\}, \tag{1}$$

where ERR denotes checker failure, including exceptions and timeouts.

This recheck ensures that contradicted or failing concepts must be revised or withdrawn before exploration continues. The agent then keeps revising its hypotheses and uses them to plan toward inferred goals or probe competing explanations.

The resulting prototype captures tested mechanisms but may describe related behaviors independently, motivating the next stage.

2.3 Structure & Simplify

The concept book may contain fragmented, overlapping descriptions of environmental mechanisms. Structure & Simplify turns these hypotheses into a compact model by identifying shared structure and reorganizing components through their relationships.

AWM first extracts the required object types, constructs a parser from observations to typed states, and rewrites concepts as rules over these objects. It then restructures these *components*—object types and rules—through four category-theory-inspired transformations. A *projective limit* assembles compatible descriptions into a coherent whole, while an *inductive limit* glues objects along shared structure (Mac Lane, 1998; Kashiwara & Schapira, 2006; Yuan, 2023). These two perspectives motivate transformations based on compatibility and shared structure, respectively (Figure 2).

Following projective limits, *decomposition* expresses a complex component through simpler components and their compatibility relations. Conversely, *composition* expresses a component through compatible existing components, moving the composite into the derived layer when a separate primitive definition is unnecessary.

Following inductive limits, *generalization* extracts shared structure from multiple components, expressing source rules c_i through a parameterized operation $r(\theta_i)$ with state-dependent θ_i. Conversely, *specialization* refines overly general components into more specific cases or introduces parameters to reduce exceptions and redundancy.

Preserving tested distinctions. Every transformation must preserve verdicts on recorded transitions. For rules, AWM also uses a diagnostic set $\mathcal{N}$ of perturbed recorded transitions to check whether simplification loses previously detected rejections.

Define $\mathrm{Rej}(c) = \{x \in \mathcal{N} : v_c(x) = \mathsf{FALSE}\}$ and $\mathrm{Rej}(S) = \bigcup_{c \in S} \mathrm{Rej}(c)$. Replacing rules S with T must preserve coverage of recorded transitions and satisfy

$$\mathrm{Rej}(T) \supseteq \mathrm{Rej}(S). \tag{2}$$

For object types, which have no checkers, transformations are evaluated by distinctions between recorded states, using state pairs as witnesses, and by rule verdicts once rules are available.

AWM applies these transformations and tests to object types, then rules, and finally rechecks object types against the settled rules. The resulting compact structure provides a common representation for formal reasoning.

2.4 Formalize & Prove

AWM completes the model in Lean 4, encoding object types as structures or inductive types, rules as `def` definitions, and derived properties as `theorem` statements. The transition function dispatches to named rules, while unresolved assumptions remain explicit theorem hypotheses rather than unchecked `axiom` declarations. Replaying recorded winning trajectories, the Lean model reproduces observed behavior on every component it represents, grounding its formal definitions in the dynamics the agent encountered. This enables theorems about all legal action sequences under the learned model, extending formal reasoning beyond the trajectories actually explored.

Proving reachability and impossibility. A level is *winnable* in the model if a legal action sequence reaches the goal. AWM proves reachability by constructing a witness checked in Lean. Impossibility can arise because the goal is unreachable, or because reaching it requires more cost than the available budget. AWM proves the former using an invariant that excludes the goal, and the latter using a lower bound on the cost of any winning sequence. For budgeted tasks, a potential V estimates the minimum remaining cost from each state and satisfies

$$V(w) \le \mathrm{cost}(w, a) + V(w') \quad \text{for every legal transition,} \qquad V(w) \le 0 \quad \text{on the goal,} \tag{3}$$

so every winning sequence costs at least $V(w_0)$, proving impossibility when this exceeds the budget. All proofs are closed and checked by the Lean kernel, without unproved placeholders (`sorry`) or kernel-bypassing computation (`native_decide`), establishing rigorous guarantees under the learned model's explicit premises. The impossibility guarantees carry over to the game when the model *over-approximates* it: every legal game transition has a model counterpart at no higher cost, with matching initial states, goals and budget semantics (Appendix A).

2.5 Example: one rule for four mechanisms

In game `lp85`, buttons move colored tiles, and a level is won when every slot holds its matching color. During Explore & Prototype, the agent discovers eleven concepts describing four button mechanisms: belts, stars, hubs, and panels (Figure 3a). In Structure & Simplify, AWM applies the generalization transformation to recognize that all four mechanisms permute tile positions, replacing the eleven concepts with a shared operation, `press_permutes`, parameterized by the pressed button. On the diagnostic set used for this merge, the shared rule retains all 55 rejections of the source concepts and rejects 21 additional corrupted transitions. The shared rule also shortens reasoning: because one color-count invariant covers every button, proofs that a variant is unsolvable need two to three times fewer lemmas than proofs over the eleven separate concepts (Appendix B.3). A separate check tests whether such a model-level proof also holds for the game: on the level-6 tile-swap variant U, Lean verifies its unsolvability proof against an engine-derived graph covering all 52,500 transitions among 7,500 configurations, with no axioms beyond Lean's standard ones (Appendix B.4).

In Formalize & Prove, Lean certifies a five-click winning sequence (Figure 3b) and proves a recolored variant unwinnable using the color-count invariant shared by all button permutations (Figure 3c). The final model contains six object types and six rules, and Lean replays all 199 recorded transitions without mismatch.

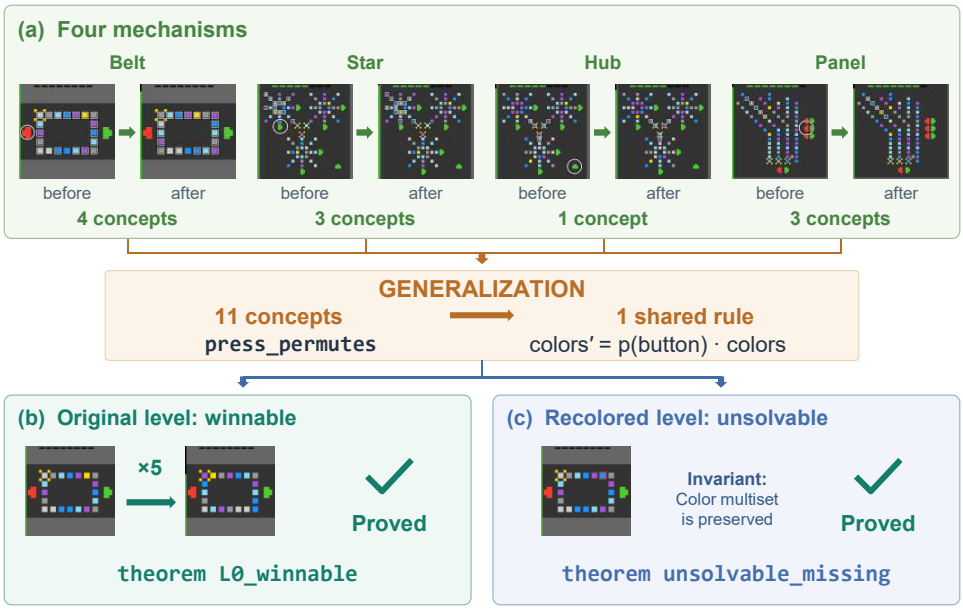


Figure 3: From shared structure to formal proofs in `lp85`. (a) Eleven concepts describing four button mechanisms are generalized into a shared permutation rule. Each before/after pair shows a recorded press, with the pressed button circled and changed tiles outlined. (b) A five-click sequence witnesses reachability. (c) Recoloring the only yellow tile makes the goal unreachable, since every press preserves color counts. Both conclusions are formally proved in Lean 4.

3 Twenty-five public games

ARC-AGI-3 (ARC Prize Foundation, 2026b) scores each level by the squared ratio of a human baseline's action count to the agent's, weights later levels more, and gives an uncleared level zero. We run AWM with Claude Opus 5 on all 25 public games (183 levels), starting each game with an empty concept book. AWM clears every level with a score of 99.9 and the fewest certified actions among the systems reporting this metric in Table 1. We further examine whether the resulting models are compact, reproduce observed behavior in Lean, and generalize beyond the trajectories from which they were learned.

Compact models that reproduce observed behavior. Across the 25 games, AWM records 742 executable concepts and withdraws 143 during model revision. The retained concepts are tested against the recorded transitions. Structure & Simplify organizes the rest into 170 object types and 283 rules, a median of 6 types and 10 rules per game. Shared patterns include translations, permutations and goal conditions. Lean replays the winning trajectory of every one of the 183 levels from its initial state and verifies its final state against the modeled goal (Table 2).

Generalization beyond observed transitions. We next test the learned rules on behavior the record never showed. We freeze the models of `lp85` and `ft09` after exploration and evaluate them on transitions from random play with previously unseen screens (seeds 0–9; Appendix B.2). The final frozen rules accept every valid transition in the new-trajectory sets. On the two modified `lp85` layout sets, they predict the next tile layout in all 4,160 cases; on the two changed-mechanic `ft09` sets, they reject all 4,031 transitions. On a third game, `ls20`, the same evaluation accepts 99.47–99.95% of valid transitions on previously unseen screens with the final rules, compared with 67–70% with the concepts before Structure & Simplify (Appendix B.2). Corruption results are reported separately in the supplement.

The changed mechanic modifies `ft09`'s hidden click pattern, causing each click to change 110 or 146 cells instead of 38; rejecting these transitions shows that the rules detect behavior inconsistent with the learned dynamics.

Table 1: Official scores on the 25 public ARC-AGI-3 games. Claude Opus 5 and GPT-6 Astra run under the official standard harness, which provides no code execution; the other systems execute code. AWM's certified clears follow uncertified sessions of the same run in 22 games. The actions for Rodionov's agent are from its ARC Prize scorecard and Memento 3's as reported in (Zhao et al., 2026).

System	Code	Mean score	Games at 100	Certified actions	Actions / human
Claude Opus 5	no	40.7	5	—	—
GPT-6 Astra	no	68.3	10	—	—
GPT-6 Astra (adapter) (ARC Prize Foundation, 2026a)	yes	100.0	25	—	—
Rodionov (2026b)	yes	99.0	23	8,347	0.49
Memento 3 (Zhao et al., 2026)	yes	100.0	25	7,518	0.44
AWM (ours)	yes	99.9	23	**7,448**	**0.43**

Table 2: Formalization and verification of the 25 learned world models in Lean 4. Axioms are those Lean's own logic uses; no proof adds axioms of its own.

Levels replayed	Rules formalized in Lean	Theorems	Axioms
183 / 183	220	1,374	only `propext`, `Classical.choice`, `Quot.sound`

Clearing the games with efficient solutions. The same models are effective for play. AWM with Opus 5 achieves a score of 99.9, compared with 40.7 for Opus 5 under the official standard harness without code execution. It scores 100 on 23 games and at least 97.6 on every game, performing competitively with leading code-executing systems (Table 1). Its certified clears require 7,448 actions, only 43% of the human baseline's 17,135 and the fewest among systems reporting this metric, compared with 7,518 for Memento 3 (Zhao et al., 2026) and 8,347 for Rodionov (2026b). Including exploration and other sessions, AWM uses 24,604 engine actions in total (Appendix B.1). These results show that AWM can construct and use explicit world models while retaining competitive solution efficiency. §4 next examines whether such models also support formal proofs of impossibility.

4 Proving impossibility

A winning trajectory establishes reachability; impossibility requires excluding every legal winning sequence within the budget, including those never explored. We test whether AWM's learned algebraic models enable such exhaustive proofs, and whether those proofs hold for the game itself.

4.1 The game, the seal, and the baselines

In `sc25`, a block moves on a grid and casts spells through a 3×3 panel to reach the exit within the level's budget. Moves and panel clicks cost one unit, completing a spell one more, fuel refunds ten, and the winning move is free. We construct two variants of levels 4 and 5 by rearranging selected elements while preserving the game mechanics, then seal them at budgets of 18 and 35. Exhaustive search on the game engine (the underlying game program), covering all four initial facings and all 13 actions, establishes minimum winning costs of 19 and 36, respectively: neither sealed level can be won, while one additional unit permits a win.

Claude Opus 5.5 and GPT-6 Astra receive the game interface and coding tools, including simulator construction and search; AWM uses Opus 5.5 with the procedure of §2 and a generic Lean skeleton. Each condition has three runs per level, with up to eight reset-delimited attempts per run, ending at game over or recorded abandonment. After each attempt, every agent is asked whether the sealed level can be won and to justify its verdict; AWM constructs Lean proofs under its learned model. Impossibility can be established by proving that the minimum winning cost exceeds the budget. We evaluate proof validity under the learned model separately from numerical agreement with the engine.

Table 3: Impossibility reasoning across six runs per agent. Bound accuracy is evaluated against the games' minimum winning costs before and after feedback-guided repair. First claim averages the earliest impossibility claim among runs making one, including later withdrawals; it is not proof-completion time. Per-run results are in Appendix C.3.

Agent	Kernel-checked model proofs	Runs claiming impossible	Correct bounds initial → feedback	First claim (attempt)
Claude Opus 5.5	0/6	3/6	1/6 → 1/6	5.3
GPT-6 Astra	0/6	2/6	0/6 → 2/6	8.0
AWM	**6/6**	**6/6**	**4/6 → 6/6**	**2.0**

4.2 Certified lower bounds

Proving beyond explored trajectories. All six AWM runs produce closed, kernel-checked Lean proofs of impossibility under their learned models and explicit premises, while none of the twelve baseline runs produces such a proof (Table 3). Crucially, these proofs exclude all legal winning sequences within the budget under the learned models, including those never explored. For example, an AWM run for level 4 proves

$$\forall B \leq 18,\ \forall \mathbf{a}, \quad \mathrm{Won}(\mathrm{run}_B(w_0, \mathbf{a})) = \mathsf{false}, \tag{4}$$

and verifies a winning witness at $B = 19$. Together, the lower bound and witness certify a tight threshold under the model, whereas finding a winning route alone cannot exclude cheaper alternatives.

AWM establishes such bounds through potential or closure certificates over arbitrary legal action lists. Certificate data may come from any search; Lean checks that the certificate proves the stated bound under the formal model, so the proof need not trust the search implementation. In our mutation tests, the Lean verification package also detects reversed bounds and mismatches between the Python and Lean versions; a separate statement audit reports vacuous premises (Appendix C.7).

Beyond unproved numerical judgments. Only five of twelve baseline runs claim impossibility, four with incorrect bounds. Even the sole correct Claude Opus 5.5 bound lists "that my hand-counted path lengths are truly minimal" as *assumed, not checked*. Finding a winning route establishes an upper bound on the minimum cost, not its optimality. AWM instead provides kernel-checked lower-bound proofs under its learned models.

Figure 4 illustrates this distinction on L4. Astra finds a winning route costing 22 and assumes it is optimal without proof, incorrectly ruling out wins at budgets 19–21. In contrast, AWM formally proves a lower bound of 19 under its learned model and verifies a matching winning witness, establishing a tight bound that agrees with the game's minimum winning cost.

Proof validity and bound accuracy are distinct. Before feedback, four of six AWM bounds are correct, compared with one for Opus 5.5 and none for GPT-6 Astra.

Some runs identify a correct winning sequence but charge the otherwise free winning move, reporting a bound one unit higher. Because this cost cannot be observed on sealed levels, we count such bounds as correct for all agents only when the discrepancy is explicitly attributable to this accounting convention, not to an incorrect route or cost estimate.

The remaining two AWM bounds, 20 on L4 and 47 on L5, arise from overly restrictive learned rules. Their proofs remain valid under those models, although their numerical thresholds disagree with the game.

4.3 Auditing premises and proving again

After the initial evaluation, the two AWM runs with bounds of 20 and 47 receive feedback only that the game permits a cheaper win, without revealing its cost, route or the faulty rule. AWM revisits its explicit rules, tests alternative formulations through interaction, and constructs new proofs under the refined models (Appendix C.4).

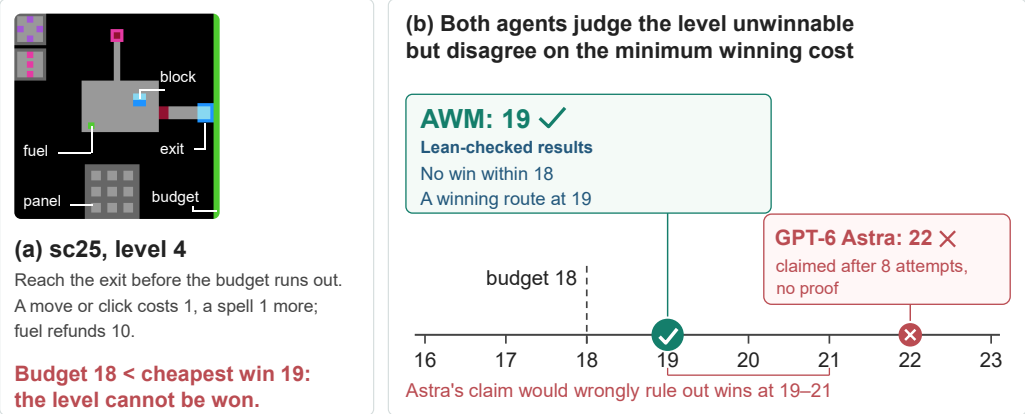


Figure 4: Sealed sc25 level 4. AWM proves in Lean that the minimum winning cost under its learned model is 19, one unit above the budget, and verifies a route at that cost; GPT-6 Astra claims 22 without a proof.

On L4, AWM discovers that growing onto fuel collects it, reducing the bound from 20 to 19. On L5, it identifies terrain rather than limited range as the cause of a failed shot, reducing the bound from 47 to 37 under its convention of charging the winning move, equivalent to the game's minimum cost of 36. Both refinements succeed within four additional attempts, each yielding a new closed Lean proof. With this feedback, AWM reaches correct bounds in all six runs.

We provide the same discrepancy feedback and additional attempt budget to the four baseline runs with incorrect bounds. Astra corrects both bounds but produces no formal proofs, while Claude Opus 5.5 corrects neither.

The proof points to the error. Both repairs revise explicit rules used by the proofs. A separate injected-error study tests whether proof dependencies help target such checks. On L4, adding these dependencies to per-rule evidence yields a transition exposing the faulty rule in 29 of 42 runs, compared with 16 of 42 given per-rule evidence alone and 30 of 42 told the faulty rule. The dependency-guided condition raises no false alarms in 12 error-free controls (Appendix C.6).

5 Related work

Executable world models. Code world models are learned from interaction for planning (Tang et al., 2024), refined by generation, testing and repair (Dainese et al., 2024) or composed from programmatic experts (Piriyakulkij et al., 2025); theory-based agents explore and plan with learned theories (Tsividis et al., 2021), and TheoryCoder-2 learns reusable abstractions for hierarchical planning (Ahmed et al., 2026). Such models are central to recent ARC-AGI-3 agents (Rodionov, 2026a; Courtis et al., 2026; Rodionov, 2026b): Twin does not act until its simulator reproduces every observed transition (Skoutnev et al., 2026), and Tycho finds that a closer match does not by itself yield better play (Lehmann et al., 2026). The closest work, Memento 3, compiles a natural-language rulebook into code and accepts an update only if an LLM judges it faithful and replay is exact (Zhao et al., 2026). Yet a code world model can pass a sampled-transition check at 100% accuracy and still lose because it misses a key rule (Aguilar Martín, 2026). AWM instead abstracts its rules into a shared structure, tests them beyond the record, and proves reachability and impossibility, checking the proofs' premises against the game.

Certified impossibility. Unsolvability certificates let an independent checker confirm that a planning task has no plan (Eriksson et al., 2017), in the spirit of certifying algorithms (McConnell et al., 2011), and certificate checking has been formally verified for temporal planning (Wang & Abdulaziz, 2025); all start from a supplied model. Impossibility transfers from an abstraction under the over-approximation condition of §2.4, budget semantics included (Clarke et al., 1994), and action-model learning gives conditions under which learned models do so (Aineto & Scala, 2024). AWM learns its

model from interaction; Lean checks every deduction from that model, and interaction checks the model's rules against the game.

Formal reasoning. Neural provers produce Lean proofs at olympiad level (Achim et al., 2025; Chen et al., 2025; Hubert et al., 2026; Ren et al., 2025), AI systems have produced Lean proofs of open Erdős problems (Sothanaphan, 2026; Tsoukalas et al., 2026), and autoformalization translates informal statements into formal ones (Wu et al., 2022). There the objects of proof are given mathematics; AWM must first infer the dynamics and costs its proofs quantify over, which makes the fidelity of its formal model an empirical question. Large-scale AI-assisted software verification proves properties of compiled programs relative to machine semantics and theorem statements, and can expose bugs during proof construction (Lucas et al., 2026). That work also studies Claude-generated x86 semantics; AWM learns the objects, action rules and goals of an unfamiliar interactive environment.

6 Limitations and conclusion

Limitations. We demonstrate AWM on ARC-like environments with discrete actions and immediate, observable feedback, where learned rules can be checked against recorded transitions; richer hidden state, delayed feedback and stochastic dynamics remain to be tested. Lean guarantees the correctness of proofs under the learned model's explicit premises, and whether these premises capture the environment is tested by interaction: the explicit rules and kernel-checked proofs separate errors in the learned model from errors in reasoning, so a discrepancy can be traced to its assumption and addressed by further exploration. Broader environments and tasks are the natural next test of such formal reasoning.

Conclusion. Formal reasoning traditionally begins with predefined objects and rules. AWM takes a step toward reasoning rigorously about unknown worlds by discovering these structures through interaction, organizing them into compact algebraic models, and formalizing them in Lean. The resulting models make learned mechanisms explicit and their behavior checkable step by step, while supporting kernel-checked proofs of reachability and impossibility, including claims about action sequences never explored. By making the assumptions behind these proofs explicit, AWM also allows discrepancies with the environment to be traced to learned rules and addressed through further exploration. Together, these capabilities bridge empirical exploration and formal reasoning, extending mathematical proof beyond problems whose definitions are given in advance.

Reproducibility statement

Public-game models and replays are available at `https://github.com/Ephemeral6/awm-site`. The readings of §2 and §3 come from the benchmark repository at commit `fa928185` (built 2026-10-24). Each game's model, tests and Lean project are regenerated by one command per game; the per-game Lean projects are checked with Lean 4.34.0 and do not use Mathlib. The readings of §4 come from the archive of the budget-sealed instance: both engine versions with their md5, the abstract model and its cross-check scripts with their raw outputs, the Lean files with their compile logs and axiom audits, every file each agent wrote, and the verbatim end-of-attempt interviews; the per-run readings are given in the appendix. The game environments are third party; official replays are linked rather than redistributed.

Statement on AI use

The agents studied in this paper are LLM agents, so AI use is part of the method. Generative AI was also used to draft and edit the text and to write the analysis scripts. All reported numbers come from script outputs over the recorded runs, not from model-generated text. The Lean proofs are checked by the Lean kernel, independently of any model.

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A METHOD DETAILS

This appendix gives the definitions behind §2: concepts and the gate (§2.2), the simplification test (§2.3), and the Lean statements, certificates and their transfer to the environment (§2.4).

A.1 Environment, concepts and the gate. We model an environment as a deterministic, goal-directed special case of a partially observable Markov decision process (Kaelbling et al., 1998): states $\mathcal{S}$, actions $\mathcal{A}$, observations $\mathcal{O}$, a transition function $T : \mathcal{S} \times \mathcal{A} \to \mathcal{S}$, an observation function $\rho : \mathcal{S} \to \mathcal{O}$ and goal states $G \subseteq \mathcal{S}$. The agent sees $o_t = \rho(s_t)$ and receives a signal when a level is cleared. A transition is a triple $x = (o, a, o')$, and a game's transition corpus $\mathcal{D}$ is the set of distinct transitions across its runs, deduplicated by content hash.

A concept $c = (\sigma_c, \alpha_c, \gamma_c, E_c)$ has an optional executable scope σ_c, an assertion α_c returning TRUE, FALSE or NA, an optional predictor γ_c, and a non-empty evidence set E_c. When the scope rejects x the verdict $v_c(x)$ is NA, otherwise it is $\alpha_c(x)$; an exception, an invalid return value or a timeout gives ERR. A concept is scored only on transitions outside E_c. The gate of Eq. (1) is enforced on the action command: it refuses the next action while the latest settlement has a FALSE or ERR verdict on any $x \in \mathcal{D}$, including the concept's own evidence. Figure 5 shows one concept.

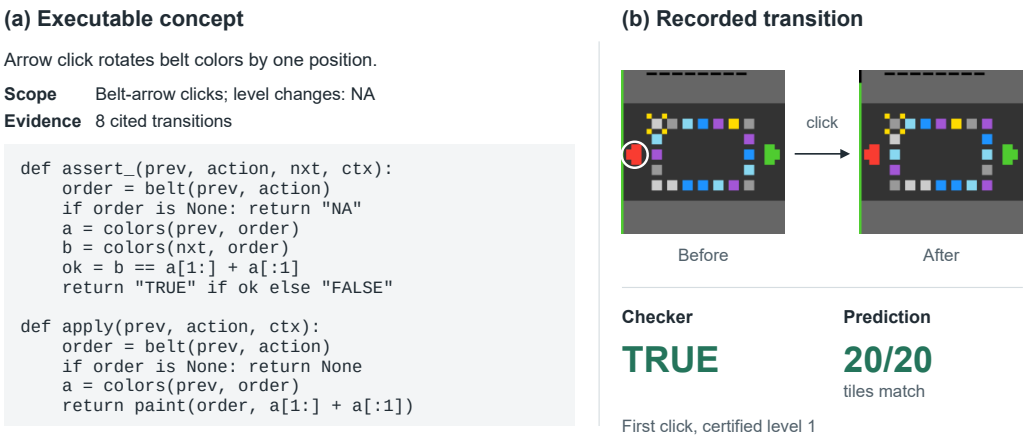


Figure 5: An executable concept in `lp85`. (a) Scope, evidence and abridged code for a click on an arrow pointing against its belt's order; helper names are simplified. (b) On the first click of the certified level-1 run, the checker returns `TRUE` and the prediction matches all 20 tiles.

A.2 Objects, rules and the simplification test. A partial parser $\pi : \widetilde{\mathcal{O}} \rightharpoonup \mathcal{W}$ maps an observation, augmented by any explicitly supplied history or auxiliary information, to a world of typed objects; $\pi(o)$ abbreviates parsing with that context. Pixel interpretation is confined to the parser, and parse failures are reported rather than guessed. A rule $r = (\sigma_r, \alpha_r)$ has a scope and an assertion on $(\pi(o), a, \pi(o'))$. The diagnostic set $\mathcal{N}$ of Eq. (2) contains at most 120 corrupted transitions per game, with a fixed seed. Each replaces part of a recorded transition (o, a, o') in one of five ways: the successor is o itself; the successor of the same action on another transition; the predecessor of another transition; o' with a few cells changed that do vary in the corpus; or another transition's o. We set

$$\mathrm{Rej}(r) = \{m \in \mathcal{N} : v_r(m) = \mathsf{FALSE}\}. \tag{A.1}$$

The following is an auxiliary diagnostic within the four transformations, not a separate operation or a sufficient deletion criterion: rule r has no unique rejection on $\mathcal{N}$ when

$$\mathrm{Rej}(r) \subseteq \textstyle\bigcup_{r' \neq r} \mathrm{Rej}(r'). \tag{A.2}$$

Any removal must preserve model behavior and pass the same before/after checks; an analogous field diagnostic fixes a field to a constant and compares verdicts on $\mathcal{D} \cup \mathcal{N}$. Figure 6 shows the test on `lp85`.

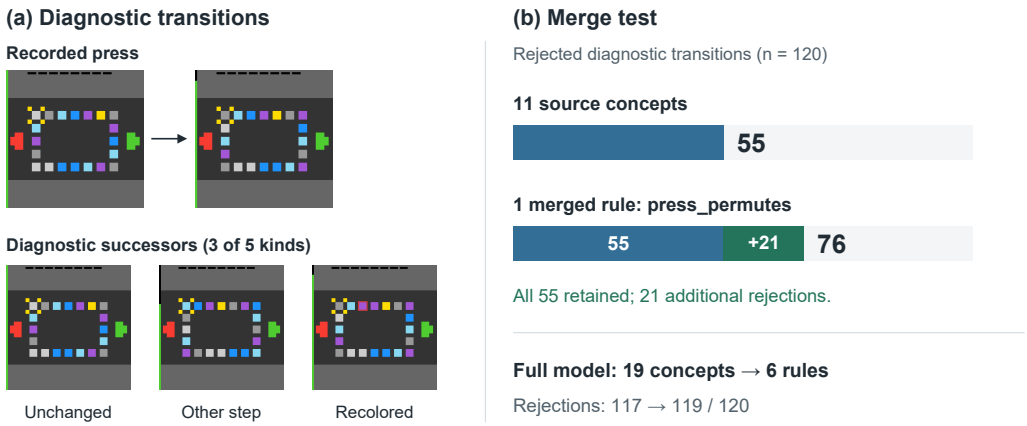


Figure 6: Testing a merge on `lp85`. (a) A recorded press and three of the five diagnostic constructions. (b) On the same 120 diagnostic transitions, `press_permutes` preserves all 55 rejections of its eleven source concepts and adds 21. Lack of unique rejections alone does not justify deletion: `dead_click`, `board_static` and `bar_never_drops` are retained based on further tests.

A.3 Lean encoding, certificates and transfer. Formalization starts from the consolidated objects and rules. AWM encodes object types as Lean `structure` or `inductive` declarations and primitive rules as executable `def` definitions; consequences derivable from these definitions are proved as `theorem` statements in the derived layer. The agent assembles the modeled transition and goal rules in `Step.lean`, whose `step` function dispatches to the named rule definitions and returns a successor or a terminal outcome for actions admitted by the model's legality conditions. For example, in `lp85`, a click either leaves the colors unchanged or applies a button's permutation, after which the goal rule determines whether the level is won; color conservation is a theorem derived from these definitions. This shared transition function is used both to replay recorded trajectories and to reason about unobserved action sequences. In `lp85`, the two budget-display rules remain in Python; Lean replays the tile dynamics and goal condition, while color conservation follows from the permutation rule (Figure 7).

On this basis, $\mathrm{everWon}(w, \bar{a})$ holds when some legal prefix of $\bar{a}$ reaches a winning outcome. The two statements of §2.4 are

$$\mathrm{Winnable}(w) :\Leftrightarrow \exists\, \bar{a}.\ \mathrm{everWon}(w, \bar{a}) = \mathsf{true}, \qquad \mathrm{Unsolvable}(w) :\Leftrightarrow \forall\, \bar{a}.\ \mathrm{everWon}(w, \bar{a}) = \mathsf{false}.$$

For level ℓ, the initial world w_0^ℓ is parsed from that level's first screen in the certified run, and the certified actions are $\bar{a}^\ell$. The reachability proof establishes $\mathrm{traceOk}(w_0^\ell, \bar{a}^\ell)$, i.e. that every computed state agrees with the recorded frame on the components the formal model represents, and $\mathrm{Winnable}(w_0^\ell)$ with $\bar{a}^\ell$ as witness. An impossibility proof establishes $\mathrm{Unsolvable}$ within a budget through a potential satisfying Eq. (3). Each theorem is closed by kernel reduction, its axioms lie within $\{$`propext`, `Classical.choice`, `Quot.sound`$\}$, and no proof uses `native_decide`; compiled with Lean 4.34.0, the published `Game.lean` of every game compiles and its `consistent` and `faithful` theorems depend only on `propext`.

The conclusions transfer to the environment under the following condition (Aineto & Scala, 2024; Clarke et al., 1994). Let $h : \mathcal{S} \to \mathcal{W}$ map concrete states, augmented with observation history where required, to modeled states.

Proposition A.1. If the model $\widehat{\mathcal{M}}$ over-approximates the environment, with matching initialization, every relevant real transition represented, real goals mapped to model goals, and cost and budget semantics that do not exclude a cheaper real execution, then

$$\mathrm{Unsolvable}_{\widehat{\mathcal{M}}}\big(h(s_0)\big) \implies \forall\, \bar{a}.\ T^{\bar{a}}(s_0) \notin G.$$

Agreement with recorded transitions establishes this premise only on the transitions it covers, so AWM states its impossibility results as $\mathrm{Unsolvable}$ of the learned model.

Proof. Suppose a legal real execution reaches a goal within budget. By matching initialization and transition simulation, induction on its prefixes gives a corresponding legal model execution. Goal preserva-

tion and the cost condition make this a model win within budget, contradicting $\mathrm{Unsolvable}_{\widehat{\mathcal{M}}}(h(s_0))$. □

B TWENTY-FIVE GAMES

This appendix gives the per-game data behind §3, Table 1 and Table 2, the test of frozen rules on unseen transitions, and the `lp85` proof sizes of §2.5.

B.1 Per-game results. Table 4 gives AWM's results and model for each game; Table 5 gives the official scores of all systems.

Table 4: AWM on each game. *Score*: official score of the certified run. *Cert.*: actions in the certified clears, which the score counts. *Sent*: every action AWM sent to the engine, including uncertified sessions, failed attempts and resets. *Human*: actions of the human baseline. *Concepts*: concepts written during play, with those withdrawn in brackets. *Rules (Lean)*: rules translated into Lean. *Replayed*: levels whose certified winning run Lean replays from the first screen to the modeled goal.

Game	Lv.	Score	Cert.	Sent	Human	Concepts	Obj. types	Rules	Rules (Lean)	Replayed
ar25	8	100.0	253	253	748	17 (3)	6	8	5	8/8
bp35	9	100.0	374	374	651	26 (4)	3	11	10	9/9
cd82	6	100.0	70	661	171	44 (13)	7	11	10	6/6
cn04	6	100.0	261	745	789	22 (1)	4	9	8	6/6
dc22	6	100.0	1,037	2,664	1,228	48 (6)	8	17	14	6/6
ft09	6	100.0	80	168	208	15 (6)	6	7	4	6/6
g50t	7	100.0	288	811	879	20 (1)	10	13	11	7/7
ka59	7	97.6	421	4,061	730	22 (8)	9	11	10	7/7
lf52	10	100.0	905	905	1,339	47 (6)	12	11	10	10/10
lp85	8	100.0	79	200	388	23 (4)	6	6	4	8/8
ls20	7	100.0	368	1,467	776	22 (3)	12	21	18	7/7
m0r0	6	100.0	215	486	1,107	26 (5)	8	9	8	6/6
r11l	6	100.0	81	184	233	26 (4)	6	9	8	6/6
re86	8	100.0	547	2,153	1,255	40 (4)	7	12	8	8/8
s5i5	8	99.3	461	2,618	638	49 (9)	5	19	17	8/8
sb26	8	100.0	124	424	213	20 (1)	6	16	12	8/8
sc25	6	100.0	146	401	350	27 (1)	5	18	11	6/6
sk48	8	100.0	263	1,407	1,070	39 (8)	6	7	4	8/8
sp80	6	100.0	138	371	518	58 (23)	3	10	6	6/6
su15	9	100.0	90	904	361	37 (15)	5	16	12	9/9
tn36	7	100.0	125	292	317	33 (9)	5	7	4	7/7
tr87	6	100.0	119	430	414	13 (3)	6	7	4	6/6
tu93	9	100.0	187	566	462	17 (0)	8	10	8	9/9
vc33	7	100.0	167	538	447	14 (0)	9	10	7	7/7
wa30	9	100.0	649	1,521	1,843	37 (6)	8	8	7	9/9
Total	183	99.9	7,448	24,604	17,135	742 (143)	170	283	220	183/183

B.2 Frozen rules on unseen transitions. We evaluate whether learned rules generalize to unseen screens and detect changes in game mechanics. For `lp85` and `ft09`, we freeze the concepts recorded during play (19 and 9, respectively) and the rules after Structure & Simplify (6 and 7). We collect transitions from random presses (seeds 0–9), retaining only states whose screens never appeared in the recorded gameplay.

Each game is evaluated on new trajectories from the original levels (T1) and two modified levels, whose winnability is verified by exhaustive search. In `lp85`, the modifications preserve the mechanics but change the layout: U moves one goal tile, making level 6 unwinnable, while D adds another swap that restores winnability. In `ft09`, the modifications change the hidden click mechanic: FU replaces level 2's click pattern with a plus shape, making it unwinnable, while FD adds a one-pixel change that restores winnability.

A rule set accepts a transition if no rule judges it false, and rejects it if at least one rule judges it false. We also generate invalid transitions using five corruption operators to test whether the rules can detect inconsistencies. Table 6 reports the results before and after Structure & Simplify. The frozen rules generalize to modified layouts in `lp85`, while detecting all tested transitions as inconsistent after the mechanic changes in `ft09`.

Table 5: Official scores on the 25 public ARC-AGI-3 games. Baselines are the official ARC Prize results: Claude Opus 5 (High) and GPT-6 Astra (Max) under the standard harness, which provides no code execution, and GPT-6 Astra (Max) under its provider-adapter harness. AWM is scored on its certified run. Rodionov's agent from its ARC Prize scorecard (Rodionov, 2026b); Memento 3 as reported in (Zhao et al., 2026).

		Official score (max 100)					
Game	Lv.	Claude Opus 5	GPT-6 Astra	GPT-6 Astra (adapter)	Rodionov (2026b)	Memento 3 (Zhao et al., 2026)	**AWM (ours)**
ar25	8	100.0	100.0	100.0	100.0	100.0	**100.0**
bp35	9	0.0	2.2	100.0	100.0	100.0	**100.0**
cd82	6	0.6	82.9	100.0	100.0	100.0	**100.0**
cn04	6	47.6	100.0	100.0	100.0	100.0	**100.0**
dc22	6	44.8	100.0	100.0	100.0	100.0	**100.0**
ft09	6	100.0	100.0	100.0	100.0	100.0	**100.0**
g50t	7	0.0	0.0	100.0	100.0	100.0	**100.0**
ka59	7	10.4	75.0	100.0	100.0	100.0	**97.6**
lf52	10	1.8	10.9	100.0	100.0	100.0	**100.0**
lp85	8	100.0	100.0	100.0	100.0	100.0	**100.0**
ls20	7	5.4	83.5	100.0	100.0	100.0	**100.0**
m0r0	6	28.6	71.4	100.0	100.0	100.0	**100.0**
r11l	6	100.0	100.0	100.0	100.0	100.0	**100.0**
re86	8	58.3	77.8	100.0	100.0	100.0	**100.0**
s5i5	8	100.0	100.0	100.0	100.0	100.0	**99.3**
sb26	8	77.8	100.0	100.0	100.0	100.0	**100.0**
sc25	6	0.0	47.6	100.0	84.2	100.0	**100.0**
sk48	8	8.3	19.7	100.0	100.0	100.0	**100.0**
sp80	6	56.3	100.0	100.0	100.0	100.0	**100.0**
su15	9	10.4	27.4	100.0	100.0	100.0	**100.0**
tn36	7	6.0	53.6	100.0	90.1	100.0	**100.0**
tr87	6	47.6	100.0	100.0	100.0	100.0	**100.0**
tu93	9	3.6	3.1	100.0	100.0	100.0	**100.0**
vc33	7	98.8	73.3	100.0	100.0	100.0	**100.0**
wa30	9	10.6	80.0	100.0	100.0	100.0	**100.0**
Mean		40.7	68.3	100.0	99.0	100.0	**99.9**
Games at 100		5	10	25	23	25	**23**

Table 6: Frozen-rule evaluation on unseen transitions, before / after Structure & Simplify (%). lp85 U/D test generalization to modified layouts, while ft09 FU/FD test detection of changed mechanics. "Wrong rejected" reports the range over the four corruption operators for which both rule sets can read both frames. The 0% acceptance on FU/FD indicates that all tested transitions violate the frozen rules: the "nothing else changes" rule detects clicks changing 110 or 146 cells instead of 38.

Set	n	Transitions accepted	Wrong rejected	Next frame predicted
lp85 T1 (new trajectories)	2,073	100 / 100	99.5–100 / 99.5–100	99.95 / 99.95
lp85 tile swap U	2,080	100 / 100	100 / 100	100 / 100
lp85 tile swap D	2,080	100 / 100	100 / 100	100 / 100
ft09 T1 (new trajectories)	2,026	99.0 / 100	99.0–100 / 100	—
ft09 pattern change FU	2,015	0 / 0	—	—
ft09 pattern change FD	2,016	0 / 0	—	—

ls20. On ls20, the concepts written during play accept 67–70% of valid transitions on unseen screens; after Structure & Simplify, the frozen rules accept 99.47–99.95% and reject 99.1–99.3% of corrupted transitions, against 71.8–100% for the concepts (Table 7). The gap comes from wall bumps: the concepts energy_tick and energy_cost charge energy for a blocked move only on the two levels where play recorded one, while the rule energy_cost charges every wall bump the level's step cost, which holds on screens the agent never saw.

Table 7: Frozen concepts and rules on two ls20 test sets of previously unseen screens (%). T1: new trajectories on the original levels; T2V: level 1 with its switch moved one cell. Corrupted rejected: range over the four corruption operators for which both sides can read both frames.

		Valid accepted		Corrupted rejected	
Test set	n	Concepts	Rules	Concepts	Rules
T1	2,017	67.0	99.95	75.3–100	99.1–99.3
T2V	2,074	70.3	99.47	71.8–100	99.1–99.2

B.3 lp85: the complete model and proof size. Figure 7 shows the complete model of lp85. To evaluate the effect of Structure & Simplify on proof construction, we compare model A, the eleven concepts recorded during play, with model B, the single merged press_permutes rule. We ask Claude Opus 5.5 to establish the solvability (with a winning click sequence) or unsolvability (with a Lean proof) of 34 tasks under each model. Each task is run three times per model, yielding 204 runs in total, and every verdict is checked against exhaustive search on the engine.

Table 8 reports proof success and complexity. Model B succeeds in all 102 runs, compared with 99 for A, and generally requires fewer auxiliary lemmas, shorter proofs, and less Lean checking time.

Table 8: Proof success and complexity for 34 lp85 tasks using the original concepts (A) or the merged rule (B). Verified counts successful runs; auxiliary lemmas, proof lines, and kernel checking time are medians over successful runs. The macro-average is the unweighted mean of the six group medians. All values are reported as A / B.

Instances	n	Verified A / B	Aux. lemmas A / B	Proof lines A / B	Kernel time (s) A / B
original levels (winnable)	24	24 / 24	0 / 0	4.5 / 4	1.00 / 0.83
goal colour removed (unwinnable)	24	24 / 24	6 / 3	75.5 / 28	0.90 / 0.80
level 6 swaps (U and D)	6	6 / 6	2 / 1.5	36.5 / 24	1.69 / 1.22
large layouts (winnable)	18	16 / 18	0 / 0	5.5 / 4	1.95 / 1.00
large layouts, altered (unwinnable)	18	17 / 18	12 / 4	117 / 49.5	2.82 / 2.41
ring spacing (unwinnable)	12	12 / 12	12 / 6.5	111 / 62.5	4.27 / 3.02
Macro avg. of medians	–	–	5.33 / 2.50	58.33 / 28.67	2.11 / 1.55
All runs	**102**	**99 / 102**	–	–	–

No run produces an incorrect verdict: A has two timeouts and one run ending without an answer. On winnable instances, both models establish reachability using a winning click sequence and decide.

B.4 Checking a model-level proof against the engine. This check concerns the level-6 tile-swap variant U of Appendix B.2. We export its engine-derived, budget-independent reachable configuration graph as a Lean table, with 7,500 configurations and 52,500 transitions for the seven nontrivial button actions. A Lean proof checks each transition against the premises of the model-level unsolvability theorem, so the conclusion transfers to the exported graph. The proof uses only Lean's standard axioms. Extracting the graph from the game engine remains outside the Lean kernel's guarantee.

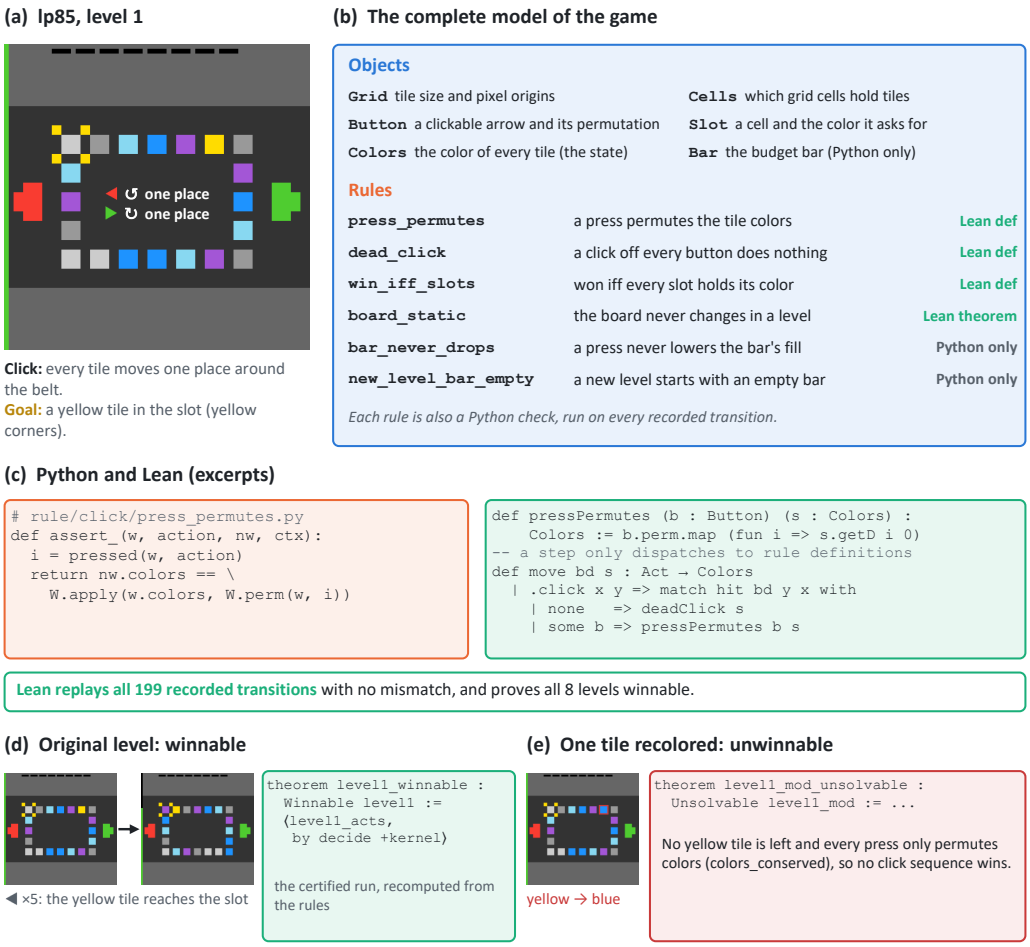


Figure 7: The complete algebraic world model of an ARC-AGI-3 game. (a) Level 1 of `lp85`: 20 colored tiles form a closed belt, and each click on an arrow moves every tile one place around the belt, counterclockwise for the left arrow and clockwise for the right; the level is won when a yellow tile stands in the slot marked by yellow corners. (b) All objects and rules of the model, with the form each takes in Lean; the two rules about the budget bar stay in Python. (c) Excerpts: one rule as its Python check, the same rule as a Lean definition, and the Lean step, which only dispatches to rule definitions. Lean replays every recorded transition of the game with no mismatch. (d) On the original level, Lean checks a winning witness, the certified run. (e) With the only yellow tile recolored, the conservation law of `press_permutes` shows that no click sequence wins. Both statements are theorems about the model.



Figure 8: The three introductory levels and two sealed evaluation levels of `sc25`, rendered from the engine in the official palette. Panels (a–c) isolate resizing, teleportation and shooting; panels (d–e) combine them. The annotations show each objective and the main stages of a minimum-budget winning route. The sealed caps, 18 and 35, are one unit below the required 19 and 36.

C Sealed levels

The sealed tasks give a known winning-cost threshold against which to assess the reasoning in §4. A proof can be valid under a learned model even when that model misstates the game. We therefore examine the initial bounds and their underlying rules, then follow the corrections through renewed proofs and checks against the engine. The final studies test how proof dependencies help locate a faulty rule and what the verification procedure itself can detect.

C.1 Construction and engine ground truth. Each task is obtained by lowering a solvable level's budget to one unit below its minimum feasible cap $B^\star$. This gives both a winning witness at $B^\star$ and a known impossible instance at $B^\star - 1$ (Table 9).

Table 9: Reference thresholds for the sealed tasks. $B^\star$ is the minimum feasible cap; "gross" adds back the fuel refund of 10. Each witness wins at $B^\star$ and fails at $B^\star - 1$, while exhaustive search finds no winning route at the sealed cap from any opening facing. Route lengths count actions, while costs use the engine's counter units.

Level	Public cap	Sealed cap	$B^\star$ (gross)	Optimal route
4	35	18	19 (29)	27 actions
5	65	35	36 (46)	42 actions

`sc25` is a deterministic, top-down puzzle game in which a block must reach an exit through walls and gates. Direction commands set its facing and move it four pixels when large (4×4) or two when small (2×2); a blocked large move also tries a two-pixel step. Matching a pattern on the 3×3 panel casts a spell: resize, teleport to a size-dependent destination, or fire a straight ray at a target to remove its gates. Walls and gates stop the ray. Direction commands and panel clicks cost one unit, spell completion costs one more, and fuel refunds ten. The winning move is free; exceeding the cap ends the attempt. The right-edge bar displays the remaining budget.

We rearrange the public levels' wall masks and object placements while preserving the transition code, existing sprite definitions, spell patterns and cost rules. Before sealing, available spells and budget caps match the public levels. Figure 8 shows the resulting tasks. Levels 1–3 introduce shrinking through a narrow corridor, teleporting into an isolated exit chamber, and shooting to open a gated passage. Their caps are 50, 25 and 50; replayed witnesses use 15, 6 and 14 actions.

Level 4 combines a target at the end of a two-pixel-wide shaft, a gate across the right exit passage, and fuel. The large block's initial movement grid misses the shaft. A minimum-budget route shrinks and regrows over the fuel, obtaining the refund and changing its alignment, then lines up a shot and exits through the opened gate. Its 27 actions require a cap of 19 (gross cost 29). Level 5 has two target–gate groups, fuel, a narrow connector and separate teleport destinations for each size. A minimum-budget route shoots the first target, collects fuel, shrinks through the connector, regrows to shoot the second target, and teleports as a large block into the exit shaft. Its 42 actions require 36 (gross cost 46). These routes minimize the required budget, rather than the unconstrained number of actions.

The witnesses establish that caps 19 and 36 suffice. To establish that lower caps cannot win, we search the sealed engine before any agent run, covering all four opening facings and all 13 actions (four moves and nine panel cells). The reachable configurations number 905,587 on level 4 and 1,423,609 on level 5. For each configuration, the search retains the least counter value, since a lower counter leaves at least as much budget for every continuation. We audit all six counter updates and both cap checks in the source. To check for effective clicks omitted by the action set, we also scan the whole 64×64 screen on 30,001 sampled frame classes per level; clicks outside the nine panel cells change none of the 13 actions' outcomes. Editing the cap field changes only the budget, so the winning and sealed instances share the same dynamics.

C.2 Agents and protocol. The comparison tests whether agents can identify the budget obstruction and justify it from interaction. Three configurations play each sealed level, three runs each. AWM uses Claude Opus 5.5 with the AWM procedure, a generic Lean skeleton and tools for recording predictions and checking rules; it receives no game rules. Claude Opus 5.5 and GPT-6 Astra without AWM receive the task, game interface and ordinary coding-agent tools.

Each run has up to eight reset-delimited attempts, ending at game over or recorded abandonment. After each attempt, the interview in Appendix D records the agent's verdict and argument. The engine reference thresholds are withheld: arenas have opaque names, contain no ground-truth file, and begin with cross-run memory cleared. This keeps the agent's reported bound separate from the reference search used to evaluate it.

C.3 Proof validity and bound accuracy. The per-run results explain why a model proof and an accurate account of the game are scored separately. All six AWM runs produce closed Lean impossibility proofs, but two initially report overly high thresholds: 20 on level 4 and 47 on level 5. Their proofs certify the learned rules; the numerical errors reveal that those rules exclude cheaper behavior allowed by the engine. Table 10 also records the baseline verdicts, including an impossibility claim later withdrawn. These individual outcomes underlie Table 3 and motivate the repair round below.

First claim records the attempt of the earliest impossibility verdict, even if later withdrawn; it is not proof-completion time. *Bound* is the least winning cost reported before feedback, in the run's own units for runs without AWM. The reference $B^\star$ is 19 on level 4 and 36 on level 5. A bound counts as correct if it equals $B^\star$ or differs only by charging the otherwise free winning move: 37 on level 5, or 42 actions against a budget of 41 in `fbac96`. This accounting allowance applies to every agent.

Table 10: Per-run verdicts, reported bounds and model proofs for the 18 runs summarized in Table 3. "Correct" evaluates the reported bound against the engine; "Lean proof" records a closed, kernel-checked impossibility theorem under the run's learned model. The text specifies the timing and cost-accounting conventions.

Level	Agent	Run	First claim	Final verdict	Bound	Correct	Lean proof
4	AWM	`9ec8d4`	2	impossible	20	no	yes
4	AWM	`69fe87`	1	impossible	19	yes	yes
4	AWM	`2a3cc5`	2	impossible	19	yes	yes
4	Claude Opus 5.5	`2f1a1c`	—	undecided	—	no	no
4	Claude Opus 5.5	`d267df`	—	undecided	—	no	no
4	Claude Opus 5.5	`1dd6e6`	—	undecided	—	no	no
4	GPT-6 Astra	`44ec53`	8	undecided	22	no	no
4	GPT-6 Astra	`4d3b31`	8	impossible	22	no	no
4	GPT-6 Astra	`98893b`	—	undecided	—	no	no
5	AWM	`284967`	3	impossible	37	yes	yes
5	AWM	`4f4628`	2	impossible	36	yes	yes
5	AWM	`977714`	2	impossible	47	no	yes
5	Claude Opus 5.5	`339b0a`	4	impossible	47–49	no	no
5	Claude Opus 5.5	`202da3`	6	impossible	43	no	no
5	Claude Opus 5.5	`fbac96`	6	impossible	42 (budget 41)	yes	no
5	GPT-6 Astra	`2cdca5`	—	undecided	—	no	no
5	GPT-6 Astra	`3eb226`	—	undecided	—	no	no
5	GPT-6 Astra	`b3830e`	—	undecided	—	no	no

C.4 Repairing the rules and proving again. The two overestimated AWM bounds provide a test of whether an explicit model can be corrected after a valid proof has been obtained. After the eight-attempt round, those runs and the four baseline runs with wrong bounds receive one piece of feedback: the engine permits a cheaper win than their analysis allows. The message reveals no rule, cost or route. AWM additionally receives a self-audit instruction to relax rules consistently with the record, test disagreements in the game, revise and prove again; the baseline message states the same discrepancy logic in plain language. Each run gets at most four further attempts.

The corrections change specific premises of the proofs (Table 11). On level 4, growing onto fuel collects it, reducing AWM's bound from 20 to 19; Figure 9 shows the missed interaction and the cheaper route. On level 5, terrain rather than limited range blocks a shot, reducing the bound from 47 to 37 under the run's convention of charging the winning move, equivalent to the engine's 36. Both repairs produce new closed Lean proofs. Astra corrects both numerical bounds without producing a formal proof, while Claude Opus 5.5 corrects neither. Thus numerical revision and renewed formal certification remain distinct outcomes of the same feedback.

Table 11: Outcomes after feedback that a cheaper win exists. The revised-rule column identifies the premise changed by AWM before proving again. Bounds of runs without AWM remain in their own units, with the budget they state. Attempts count additional attempts in the repair round.

Run	Level	Attempts	Rule revised	Bound after	Lean proof
AWM `9ec8d4`	4	4	growing onto fuel collects it	19	yes
AWM `977714`	5	4	terrain, not range, stops the shot	37	yes
GPT-6 Astra `44ec53`, `4d3b31`	4	$\leq$4	—	19 (both)	no
Claude Opus 5.5 `339b0a`, `202da3`	5	$\leq$4	—	42 (budget $\sim$40), 68 (budget 64)	no

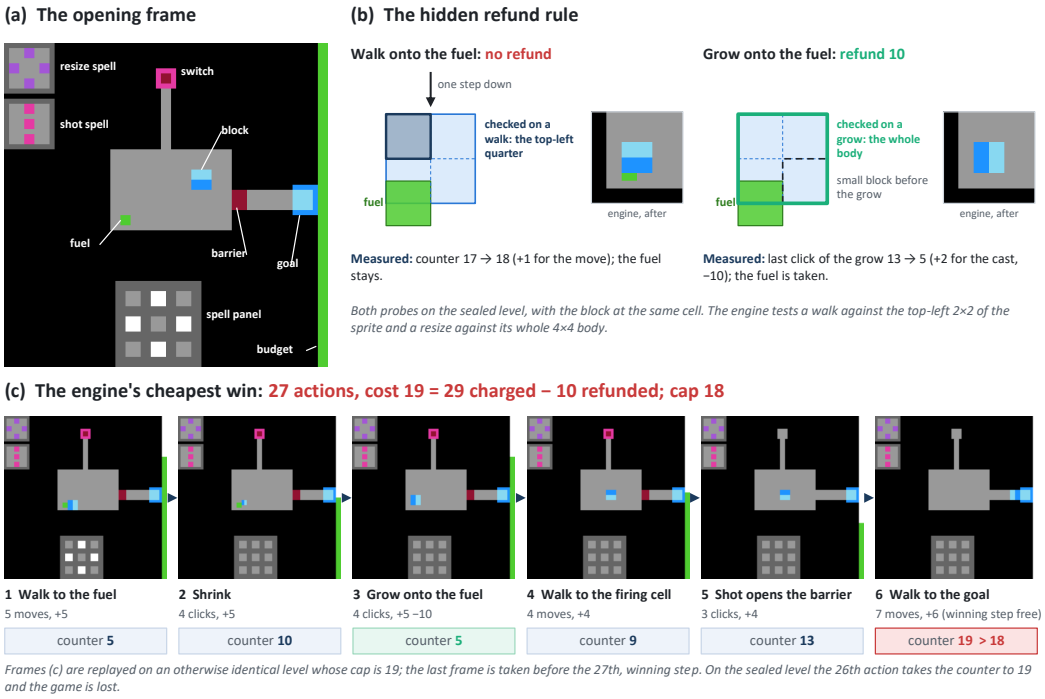


Figure 9: Why the level-4 model needed revision. (a) The opening. (b) Walking checks only the large block's top-left quarter for fuel, whereas growing checks its full footprint and can collect fuel under the bottom-left quarter, refunding 10. Missing this distinction led one AWM run to report 20. (c) The cheaper witness uses 27 actions and requires 19. It is replayed at cap 19; at the sealed cap 18, action 26 ends the game. All frames come from the engine.

C.5 Checking the repaired certificate against the engine. A corrected numerical threshold alone does not establish that the model captures every relevant game transition. We therefore perform a separate engine-assisted check on a repaired level-5 model. Transitions refuted by the engine are replaced with the observed ones, and the winning move is charged as the engine charges it. The resulting model gives a bound of 36.

We then evaluate its certificate on every non-terminal engine transition reachable within cap 35 from the opening produced by `set_level`: 17,194,487 transitions, reduced to 32,523 distinct abstract queries, with no violation. This checks the certificate conditions on the specified budget-bounded engine region, supplying evidence for transfer beyond agreement on a few replayed routes. Its coverage is this fixed opening and cap; the four-opening reference search in §C.1 serves a different purpose, establishing the task's ground-truth threshold.

C.6 Using proof dependencies to locate a faulty rule. The repairs above identify concrete rules that blocked cheaper solutions. To measure whether proof dependencies help find such rules, we inject a known single-rule error into a reference model that matches the engine under the abstractions of §C.1. The main sample comprises the 14 level-4 and 7 level-5 injections that change the model's least winning cost, each run with seeds 1–3.

Claude Opus 5.5 receives the faulty model, its proof and a service for probing the sealed engine. C1 adds a per-rule evidence table; C2 adds the proof's rule dependencies to the same table, without naming the faulty rule. R provides a reference condition in which that rule is named. C0 probes randomly without an agent, and EX searches the engine exhaustively. A discovery requires an observed transition, within the faulty rule's scope, on which the engine and model disagree. It is counted in engine actions to the first such observation, with budgets of 50 actions on level 4 and 5,000 on level 5. Naming a rule in the final report is recorded separately from exposing its error through interaction.

Table 12 shows where the added dependency information helps. On level 4, C2 discovers the conflict in 29 of 42 runs, compared with 16 of 42 for C1 and 30 of 42 when the faulty rule is named. Level 5 remains harder: discovery is 3 of 21 for C2 and 1 of 21 for C1. Most of the improvement in the main sample therefore comes from level 4; the aggregate difference and error-free controls are reported with the table.

Table 12: Counterexample discovery with injected rule errors: 14 injections on level 4 and 7 on level 5, each with three seeds. *Found*: discovery within the action budget. *Median*: Kaplan–Meier median actions to discovery, censored at the budget. *Named*: the conflict log or final model identifies the faulty rule. EX has no action budget. Across the 63 sample–seed pairs, C2's discovery rate exceeds C1's by 0.238 (sample-clustered bootstrap 95% interval $[0.079, 0.397]$). On 12 error-free controls, C2 raises 0.00 false alarms per run and C1 0.33.

Arm	L4 found	L4 median	L5 found	L5 median	Found (L4 + L5)	Named	Tokens (median)
C0 random	12/42	> 50	0/21	> 5000	12/63	—	—
C1 per-rule evidence	16/42	> 50	1/21	> 5000	17/63	35/63	2.35M
C2 proof dependencies	29/42	27	3/21	> 5000	32/63	50/63	3.29M
R faulty rule named	30/42	26	5/21	> 5000	35/63	61/63	1.98M
EX exhaustive	14/14	136,852	1/7	—	15/21	—	—

The level-5 comparison reported with 42 paired runs per arm uses the same 5,000-action discovery criterion: C2 finds the conflict in 8 of 42 runs and C1 in 5 of 42 (Table 13). These results retain their own denominator alongside the 21-run level-5 results above.

Table 13: The level-5 comparison reported with 42 paired runs per arm, using the same discovery criterion and 5,000-action budget. Its denominator is reported separately from the 21-run level-5 sample in Table 12.

Arm	L5 found	Discovery rate
C1 per-rule evidence	5/42	11.9%
C2 proof dependencies	8/42	19.0%

C.7 What the verification procedure checks. A checked proof establishes that a conclusion follows from its formal definitions and premises; correspondence with the game is assessed separately. To distinguish these guarantees, we introduce 21 mutations into each of three models: the sealed-level reference models (2,675 and 3,502 states) and the merged `lp85` model (869 states). Mutations affect certificate generation (G), model definitions (M1–M6), one of the Python or Lean representations (M7), or theorem statements (S1–S7). We compare a Python search for the least winning budget (V1), a Python checker of certificate conditions (V2), and Lean proof checking with an additional statement audit (V3).

Both V2 and V3 reject all 12 invalid certificates, including nine whose conclusions are false in the engine (Table 14). V3 additionally detects the tested Python–Lean mismatches (3/3) and reversed bounds (3/3); its separate statement audit flags six vacuous-premise or empty-start-set cases. These six

theorems may still compile: the Lean kernel checks deductions from stated premises, not whether those premises are meaningful for the game.

None of the routes detects the injected model-definition errors (M1–M6) or the wrong-goal and model-version statements (S3, S7). The test therefore isolates what the verification pipeline checks beyond certificate validity, while also showing why interaction and engine-level checks remain necessary to connect the formal specification to the game.

Table 14: Mutation detection across three models. V1 searches in Python; V2 checks certificates in Python; V3 combines Lean proof checking with a separate statement audit. Vacuous premises and empty start sets are flagged by the audit, not rejected by the kernel. "n/a" denotes a mutation outside a route's inputs; undetected model and statement errors delimit the checks' scope.

Mutant	V1 Python search	V2 Python checker	V3 Lean + audit
generator error: invalid certificate rejected	n/a	12/12	12/12
of which the conclusion is false on the engine	n/a	9/9	9/9
model error (M1–M6) rejected	none	none	none
Python and Lean versions differ (M7) rejected	0/3	0/3	3/3
vacuous premises or empty start set (S1, S2) reported	0/6	0/6	6/6
reversed bound (S4) rejected	n/a	0/3	3/3
wrong goal set, other model version (S3, S7) rejected	none	none	none

D Interview prompts

This appendix reproduces verbatim the interview of Appendix C.2. After each attempt the harness sends questions 1–3, the formalization questions (AWM runs only) and the verdict lines, in the same session as the play; the level is then reset with the retry message. After the last attempt the final interview replaces questions 1–3 and keeps the same verdict lines.

Questions 1–3, every run.

```
That attempt failed. The game will reset this level, and you may get another attempt.

Answer the following. Keep it to what it needs; do not pad.

1. What happened on the level you were on when the attempt ended, and what do you think made
   it fail? Explain in plain prose, as if to someone who did not watch you play.

2. Do you still see a way to beat this level?
   - If you do: say what it is, and what you would still need to check to be sure of it.
   - If you no longer do: say why not. State precisely what you are claiming, give the
     argument for it, and make clear what the argument rests on - which parts you established
     and which are assumptions you did not check. Someone else should be able to follow it and
     judge whether it holds. The form of the argument is yours to choose.
   - If you cannot tell either way, say so, and say what would settle it.

3. What will you do on the next attempt?
```

Formalization questions, AWM runs.

```
4. Before you answer this one, bring your formal system up to date. It is the thing you are
   building across attempts; the proof is downstream of it. Work in this order, in your
   working directory:

   a. Objects. What things are on the board, and what slots does each thing carry? For every
      object you keep, you should be able to name a pair of positions that stop being
      distinguishable if you drop it.
   b. Rules. Write each rule as a function: given a position and an action, what does it
      change? Each rule needs a domain you can actually execute.
   c. Simplify. Drop slots no rule reads. Merge rules that always decide alike. After this,
      your model's verdict on every frame you have observed must be unchanged.
   d. Formalize. Turn the objects and rules into Lean *definitions* - not theorems. Each rule
      ends up in exactly one of three states: a definition, a consequence of definitions, or
```

```
      explicitly marked "not in the model".

   If you already have a formal system from an earlier attempt, **amend it. Do not start a new
   one.** What you learned this attempt is a change to specific objects, rules or definitions;
   make those changes and leave the rest alone. A rewrite throws away the part of your work
   that was already right, and it destroys the record of what this attempt actually taught you.

5. Now prove your answer to question 2 **on that formal system**: that the level can be won,
   or that it cannot.

   - The proof must compile, and `#print axioms` on your main theorem must come back clean -
     no `sorryAx`, no `native_decide`. Report that output verbatim.
   - Say what your theorem actually quantifies over and what it assumes. If the proof needs a
     premise you did not establish, write it as an explicit hypothesis rather than burying it
     in a definition.
   - Name the rules from step 4b that your theorem leans on. If your Lean definitions carry
     something your rules do not - an extra assumption, a tighter domain, a step treated as
     atomic - say so here. A proof that is clean about the wrong system is worth nothing, and
     a model that is *stricter* than the game is the dangerous direction: "impossible in my
     model" does not transfer to the game.
   - Put the file in `lean/` and tell me its filename.
   - If you cannot complete the proof, say exactly where it breaks and what is missing. An
     honest "it does not go through, here is the gap" is worth more than a theorem that proves
     something weaker than it looks.

6. If this attempt taught you nothing that changes your formal system - no rule revised, no
   definition touched - do not invent a change. Say so instead, on its own line, in exactly
   this form, and then give the reason:

       FORMAL-UNCHANGED: <why this attempt added nothing to the model - what you tried, what
       you already knew, and what would have had to happen for the model to change>

   "No change, and here is why" is a real result. A change made only to look busy is not.
```

Verdict lines.

AWM runs.

```
End your reply with exactly these two lines, on lines of their own, with nothing after them:

VERDICT: winnable | impossible | impossible_in_model_proved | impossible_in_model | undecided
CONFIDENCE: <an integer from 0 to 100>

The two "in_model" words are for when the level cannot be won under the rules you yourself
measured, and the step from "those rules" to "the real game" is an assumption you are stating
rather than something you established. Say which assumption, in your answer to question 2.
Use `impossible_in_model_proved` only if you are also handing over a Lean proof of it that
compiles and whose `#print axioms` is clean - name the file. Otherwise use `impossible_in_model`.
Your proof will be compiled and its axioms checked, so do not claim `_proved` on a file that
does not go through; `impossible_in_model` with an honest account of the gap is worth more.

Answer in writing only. Do not send any more game actions.
```

Baseline runs.

```
End your reply with exactly these two lines, on lines of their own, with nothing after them:

VERDICT: winnable | impossible | undecided
CONFIDENCE: <an integer from 0 to 100>

Answer in writing only. Do not send any more game actions.
```

Retry message.

```
You have another attempt on that level.

`POST /reset` restarts the level you were on; the levels you already beat stay beaten, and the
level's own counters start over. Play it again, as far as you can. When the attempt ends, stop
and report as before.
```

Final interview, questions.

```
That attempt failed.

Answer the following in writing. Give each answer the length it needs; do not pad.

1. What happened on the level you were on, and what do you think made it fail?
   Explain in plain prose, as if to someone who did not watch you play.

2. Do you still see a way to beat this level?
   - If you do: give the line of play, and say what you checked it against.
   - If you no longer do: say why not. State precisely what you are claiming, give the
     argument for it, and make clear what the argument rests on - which parts you established
     and which are assumptions you did not check. Someone else should be able to follow it and
     judge whether it holds. The form of the argument is yours to choose.
   - If you cannot tell either way, say so, and say what would settle it.

3. Which rule did you newly work out across these attempts, and from which observation?

4. Which rule are you still unsure about, and unsure in what way?
```